

Joshua Taft Leinwand

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317 North Chester Road
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Research Interests: Economics of Education, Industrial Organization, Labor Economics, Public Economics

Education

Swarthmore College, B.A.(3.8) Honors Economics Major, Honors Philosophy Minor, Math Minor **May 2027**
- Student Government Chair of Academic Affairs, NCAA D3 Cross Country/Track and Field Team, Student-Athlete Advisory Committee Representative, McCabe Scholars Executive Board Member, Volunteering Club
Oxford University, St. Anne's College, Philosophy, Politics, and Economics Visiting Student **December 2025**
- Oxford Economics Society, Oxford University Cross Country
Yarmouth High School, Summa Cum Laude **June 2023**

Working Papers

"Estimating Intergenerational Effects of Early Age Human Capital Investment" **August 2026**
- Stephen O'Connell, Michael Vinh Pham, Joshua Leinwand, Working Paper
"Market Structure and Cost Pass-Through in Retail Gasoline" **August 2026**
- Joshua Leinwand, Working Paper

Work Experience

Microeconomics TA for Dr. Erin Bronchetti, Swarthmore College **August 2026-Present**
- Ran weekly TA clinic sessions, as well as offered individualized tutoring for students in Intermediate Microeconomics, assisting in exam preparation, working through homework, and general microeconomics course content.
- Assisted in providing grading and feedback for 127 students across weekly problem sets.
Senior Admissions Fellow, Swarthmore College **June 2026-Present**
- Administered in-person and online admissions interviews for prospective students, in service of providing information to admissions staff in order to make more informed decisions about shaping the incoming class.
- Provided weekly information sessions for admissions to prospective students and families about both the admissions process and Swarthmore College as a whole.
- Collaborated with admissions staff on various as-needed projects and duties, including helping organize student fly-in programs.
Economics Research Assistant for Dr. Stephen O'Connell, Swarthmore College **March 2026-Present**
- Research assistant for "Estimating Intergenerational Effects of Early Age Human Capital Investment," developed an integrated Python and Julia research pipeline for estimating intergenerational human-capital formation, connecting longitudinal NLSY/CEX data, Attanasio et al. (2020)-style latent-factor and nested-CES technology estimates, and a three-period Del Boca et al. (2014) parental-investment model.
- Redesigned the structural estimation architecture around Simulated Method of Moments, benchmarked global optimization methods, and implemented threaded DX-NES with adaptive Metropolis sampling; improved large-sample performance through parallel dynamic programming household simulation.
- Built and validated longitudinal public-investment and household-expenditure datasets by merging and reconciling Head Start records and 23 years of CEX data with restricted NLSY data within a Windows Virtual Data Enclave as a Bureau of Labor Statistics approved agent
- Promoted to co-author for significant empirical contributions
Macroeconomics TA for Dr. Stephen O'Connell, Swarthmore College **December 2025-May 2026**
- Ran weekly TA clinic sessions, as well as offered individualized tutoring for students in Intermediate Macroeconomics, assisting in exam preparation, working through homework, and general macroeconomic course content.
- Assisted in providing grading and feedback for 109 students across weekly problem sets.
Economics Research Assistant for Dr. Marc Remer, Swarthmore College **December 2024-December 2025**

- Primary research assistant for project “An Analysis of the Connection Between the Structure of Markets and Lobbying Expenditures,” performing literature review in the fields of common ownership and economic models of lobbying.
- Integrated longitudinal financial datasets using CUSIP and PERMCO identifier crosswalks between scraped OpenSecrets lobbying and WRDS institutional investment data, resolving inconsistent data types, missing identifiers, duplicate observations, and quarter-to-date alignment issues across large merges.
- Built and debugged Python pipelines to calculate firm-level measures of common ownership using institutional-investor holdings data, producing reproducible annual Parquet datasets to calculate inter-firm profit weightings using methodology from Backus, Conlon, & Sinkinson (2020).
- Performed comprehensive literature review, screening, and scraping of potential papers for input data to be used in hierarchical Bayesian models to estimate a universal merger price effect for “Price Effects in U.S. Merger Retrospectives: A Meta-Analytic Approach.

Student Academic Mentor, Swarthmore College

August 2024-Present

- Provide on-demand assistance to students on academics, course registration, major planning, study strategies, and finding research within a designated dorm room throughout the year.
- Work with other SAMs to create programming aimed at assisting entire grades with major planning and registration.

Board Member, Maine State Board of Education

July 2021-August 2023

- Served on the Student Life, Student Selection, and School Construction Committees; collaborated on drafting policy initiatives and revising the board's strategic goals and state educational standards
- Led the revision of Maine Rule Chapter 115, broadening emergency teacher certifications statewide, and authored a report on student mental health in Maine presented to the Maine State Senate Education and Cultural Affairs Committee.
- Reviewed and approved major capital construction requests and college degree-granting authority renewals across the state.

Fit Specialist, Fleet Feet Maine Running Company

June 2023-June 2025

- Footwear and apparel sales; Top Salesperson (June, July 2024)

Trail Crew Volunteer, Royall River Conservation Trust

April 2020-August 2023

- Trail construction, maintenance, and invasive species removal

Apprentice Builder, Hebert Construction

June 2022-August 2022

- Construction and renovation of low-income and commercial housing

Relevant Coursework

Introduction to Econometrics, Econometrics, Intermediate Microeconomics, Intermediate Macroeconomics, Honors Antitrust & Market Regulation, Calculus 1, Calculus 2, Multivariable Calculus, Linear Algebra, Probability, Real Analysis, Mathematical Statistics, Data Structures and Algorithms, Ethics & AI, Ethics & Economics

Awards

McCabe Scholar, Swarthmore College

April 2023

- Full-tuition, full-year, merit-based scholarship awarded based on leadership and academic achievement. One of only two students in the Class of 2027 to receive this award at a national level.

Economic Justice Internship Prize, Swarthmore College

March 2026

- \$6,000 research grant awarded for the project “Estimating Intergenerational Effects of Early Age Human Capital Investment.”

Sam Hayes Research Grant, Swarthmore College

March 2025

- \$6,000 research grant awarded for the project “An analysis of the connection between the structure of markets and lobbying expenditures”.

4x Centennial Honor Roll

(2024-25, 2025, 2025-26, 2026)

- Awarded by the Centennial Conference to student-athletes of sophomore standing or higher possessing a cumulative GPA of 3.40 or higher.

Skills: Python(numpy, pandas, matplotlib, seaborn), Julia, LaTeX, GitHub, Stata

Citizenship: United States

Languages: English(Native)